Meridian Technologies

Vendor Management Framework

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Team: Vendor Management

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1. Purpose

This framework establishes a consistent process for selecting, evaluating, onboarding, monitoring, and reviewing external vendors that provide services or resources to Meridian Technologies.

2. Scope

This framework applies to external service providers, software vendors, infrastructure suppliers, consulting partners, and other third parties engaged by the company.

3. Vendor Selection

Before engaging a vendor, the requesting team must document:

- Business requirement and expected deliverables.
- Estimated cost and proposed contract duration.
- Vendor experience and service capabilities.
- Security and compliance requirements.
- Operational dependencies and potential risks.

Vendor selection must follow the company's procurement approval process. Price alone must not determine vendor selection.

4. Vendor Onboarding

Before a vendor is approved for operational use:

1. The requesting department submits a vendor onboarding request.
2. Operations verifies the business requirement.
3. Finance reviews the commercial terms and budget availability.
4. IT and Security reviews access and security requirements where applicable.
5. Procurement records the approved vendor and contract details.

Vendors must receive only the minimum access required to perform their contracted responsibilities.

5. Vendor Performance Monitoring

Vendor performance is reviewed using the following criteria:

Evaluation Area	Measurement
Service quality	Accuracy and quality of delivered services
Timeliness	Compliance with agreed delivery schedules
Reliability	Frequency of service interruptions
Responsiveness	Time taken to respond to requests
Compliance	Adherence to contractua

	l and security requirements
Cost management	Compliance with approved commercial terms

Critical vendors should be reviewed quarterly. Other vendors should be reviewed at least annually.

6. Vendor Risk Management

The Operations team maintains a record of vendor-related risks, including service dependency, delivery delays, financial exposure, security concerns, and availability of alternative providers.

Critical vendors must have an identified internal owner and a documented escalation contact.

7. Contract Management

Vendor contracts must specify deliverables, payment terms, service expectations, confidentiality requirements, renewal conditions, and termination procedures.

Contract renewals must be reviewed before the expiration date. Unapproved extensions or changes to commercial terms are not permitted.

8. Vendor Offboarding

When a vendor relationship ends:

- The requesting department confirms completion or termination of services.
- IT and Security revokes vendor system access.
- Finance verifies outstanding payments and invoices.
- Operations updates the vendor register.
- Company information and assets must be returned or securely disposed of according to applicable policy.

9. Review and Compliance

The Vendor Management Team is responsible for maintaining this framework and ensuring that vendor records are updated.

Exceptions must be documented and approved by the relevant department authority.

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